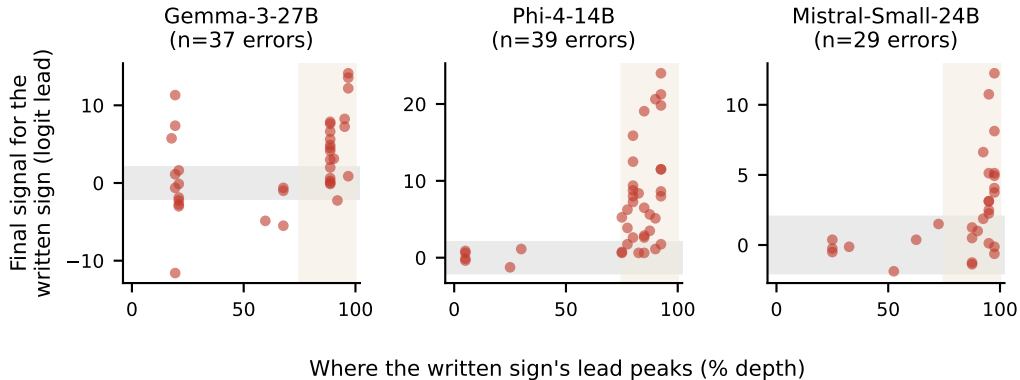


Small models show the same late decision



Same axes as Fig. 1, for three small models (determinant errors only; no matched correct set was run). Of 56 problems with a clear final signal (lead > 2), 53 peak in the last quarter. Gemma's 3 mid-depth exceptions trace to a measured early — lean (a lead > 2 for — in 95% of its problems at layers 8–13, erased by mid-network); Phi and Mistral show no such lean. Gray band: no clear signal at any layer.